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ENFORCEMENT OF ENTERPRISE BROWSER USE

Abstract

Web browser control by configuring a web browser to send to a second computer server, in response to a request by a user of the web browser to access a resource at a first computer server, an authentication token and the request to access the resource, where the second computer server is configured to determine whether the authentication token is valid, and if the authentication token is valid, whether the request to access the resource is authorized, and send to the first computer server, if the request to access the resource is authorized, the request to access the resource, and where the request sent by the second computer server is sent via an intermediary configured to block attempts to access the first computer server that are received from a sender network address that is not a predefined valid network address of the second computer server.

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Background/Summary

BACKGROUND

[0001] Web browser are among the most widely used computer software applications. Organizations, including commercial business enterprises and government bodies, are increasingly dependent on the use of web browsers by those who work on their behalf. Organizations that wish to exercise control over web browsers, such as to audit their use and prevent them from downloading malware or transmitting sensitive information outside of the organization, are typically forced to implement various measures that are external to web browsers, such as on computers that host web browsers and on network infrastructure through which web browsers communicate. Unfortunately, such measures are often costly and complex to configure and manage, lack visibility to all aspects of internal web browser operation, can impede web browser users from accomplishing their work tasks efficiently, and are too often thwarted by successful attempts to bypass them.

SUMMARY

[0002] In one aspect of the invention a method of web browser control is provided, the method including configuring a web browser to send to a first computer server a request by a user of the web browser to access a resource at the first computer server, where the first computer server is configured to associate the computer user with a predefined identity provider network address, and redirect the web browser to access the identity provider network address, and configuring the web browser to send to a second computer server, in response to receiving the identity provider network address from the first computer server, an authentication token and a request to access the identity provider network address, where the second computer server is configured to determine whether the authentication token is valid, determine, if the authentication token is valid, whether the request to access the identity provider network address is authorized, and send to the identity provider, if the request to access the identity provider network address is authorized, the request to access the identity provider network address, and where the identity provider is configured to associate the identity provider network address for use with incoming requests from the second computer server, and block attempts to access the identity provider network address that are received from a sender network address that is not a predefined valid network address of the second computer server.

[0003] In another aspect of the invention the web browser is configured with the authentication token.

[0004] In another aspect of the invention the second computer server is configured to determine whether the request to access the identity provider network address is authorized by determining whether the user of the web browser is authorized to access the identity provider network address.

[0005] In another aspect of the invention the second computer server is configured to determine whether the request to access the identity provider network address is authorized by determining whether a tenant associated with the user of the web browser is authorized to access the identity provider network address.

[0006] In another aspect of the invention the identity provider is configured with the predefined valid network address of the second computer server.

[0007] In another aspect of the invention the second computer server relays communications

between the web browser and the identity provider until the user is authenticated by the identity provider and redirected by the identity provider to access the resource to which the user originally requested access at the first computer server.

[0008] In another aspect of the invention a method of web browser control is provided, the method including configuring a web browser to send to a second computer server, in response to a request by a user of the web browser to access a resource at a first computer server, an authentication token and the request to access the resource at a first computer server, where the second computer server is configured to determine whether the authentication token is valid, determine, if the authentication token is valid, whether the request to access the resource at the first computer server is authorized, and send to the first computer server, if the request to access the resource at the first computer server is authorized, the request to access the resource at the first computer server, and where the request sent by the second computer server is sent via an intermediary configured to block attempts to access the first computer server that are received from a sender network address that is not a predefined valid network address of the second computer server.

[0009] In another aspect of the invention the intermediary is any of a firewall, a load balancer, and a reverse proxy.

[0010] In another aspect of the invention the second computer server relays between the web browser and the first computer server communications that are not blocked by the intermediary.

[0011] In another aspect of the invention a method of web browser control is provided the method including configuring a web browser to send to a first computer server a request by a user of the web browser to access a resource at the first computer server, where the first computer server is configured to associate the computer user with a predefined identity provider network address at an identity provider, provide a Security Assertion Markup Language (SAML) request to the web browser, and redirect the web browser to send the Security Assertion Markup Language (SAML) request to the identity provider network address, where the identity provider is configured to authenticate the user, provide a SAML response to the web browser, and redirect the web browser to send the SAML response to a second computer server, and configuring the web browser to send to the second computer server, in response to receiving the SAML response from the identity provider, an authentication token and the SAML response, where the second computer server is configured to determine whether the authentication token is valid, determine, if the authentication token is valid, whether the request to access the resource at the first computer server is authorized, and send to the first computer server, if the request to access the resource at the first computer server is authorized, the SAML response together with the request to access the resource at the first computer server, and where the first computer server is configured to determine whether the SAML response is valid and, if the SAML response is valid, allow the user to access the resource.

[0012] In another aspect of the invention a method of web browser control is provided, the method including configuring a web browser to send a predefined identifier in a communication sent by the web browser, where a destination of the communication is indicated within the communication, and configuring an intermediary to receive the communication, determine whether the identifier is present within the received communication, allow the received communication to proceed to the destination of the communication if the identifier is present within the received communication, and prevent the received communication from proceeding to the destination of the communication if the identifier is not present within the received communication.

[0013] In another aspect of the invention the identifier is a digital token, header, or certificate.

[0014] In another aspect of the invention the web browser is configured to include the identifier in all communications sent by the web browser.

[0015] In another aspect of the invention the web browser is configured to include the identifier in communications sent by the web browser to one or more predefined destinations.

[0016] In another aspect of the invention the intermediary is configured to determine whether the identifier is present within the communication received from a predefined origin.

[0017] In another aspect of the invention the predefined origin includes one or more predefined network addresses.

[0018] In another aspect of the invention the predefined origin includes the network address of a computing device that hosts the web browser.

[0019] In another aspect of the invention a method of web browser control is provided, the method including installing a web browser on a computer that is configured to route to an intermediary all communications sent by the computer, where the first intermediary is configured to prevent some or all of the communications from proceeding to destinations that are indicated within the communications, and configuring the web browser to override the configuration of the computer and allow all of the communications sent by the web browser to proceed to destinations that are indicated within the communications sent by the web browser, where the computer and the intermediary are protected in accordance with an access-control technique making them configurable only by authorized personnel.

[0020] In another aspect of the invention the intermediary is a proxy server.

[0021] In another aspect of the invention the configuring includes configuring the web browser to override the configuration of the computer and route to a second intermediary all communications sent by the web browser, where the second intermediary is configured to allow all of the communications sent by the web browser to proceed to destinations that are indicated within the communications sent by the web browser.

[0022] In another aspect of the invention the configuring includes configuring the web browser with empty proxy settings for all communications sent by the web browser, thereby enabling all of the communications sent by web browser to proceed to destinations that are indicated within the communications sent by the web browser without being routed through the intermediary.

[0023] In another aspect of the invention a method of web browser control is provided, the method including installing a web browser on a computer that is configured to use a first Domain Name System (DNS) server to resolve domains of all Uniform Resource Locators (URLs) to which access is requested by software or hardware installed on the computer, where the first DNS server is configured to not correctly resolve all domain resolution requests that the first DNS server receives, and configuring the web browser to override the configuration of the computer and use a second DNS server to resolve domains of all URLs to which access is requested by the web browser, where the second DNS server is configured to correctly resolve all domain resolution requests that the second DNS server receives, where the computer and the first and second DNS servers are protected in accordance with an access-control technique making them configurable only by authorized personnel.

[0024] In another aspect of the invention the first DNS server is configured to resolve any of the domain resolution requests that the first DNS server receives to a predefined blocking web page at a domain that is not associated with the domains of the requested URLs.

[0025] In another aspect of the invention the second DNS server is configured as a secure DNS server that requires that access to the second DNS server be authenticated with an authentication token, and where the web browser is configured with the authentication token.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

[0026] Aspects of the invention will be understood and appreciated more fully from the following detailed description taken in conjunction with the appended drawings in which:

[0027] FIG. 1 is a simplified conceptual illustration of a system for enforcing enterprise browser use, constructed and operative in accordance with an embodiment of the invention;

[0028] FIG. 2 is a simplified action diagram of an exemplary method of web browser

authentication for use with the system of FIG. 1, operative in accordance with an embodiment of the invention;

[0029] FIG. 3 is a simplified action diagram of an exemplary method of web browser control for use with the system of FIG. 1, operative in accordance with an embodiment of the invention;

[0030] FIG. 4 is a simplified action diagram of an exemplary method of web browser control for use with the system of FIG. 1, operative in accordance with an embodiment of the invention;

[0031] FIG. 5 is a simplified action diagram of an exemplary method of web browser control for use with the system of FIG. 1, operative in accordance with an embodiment of the invention;

[0032] FIG. 6 is a simplified action diagram of an exemplary method of web browser control for use with the system of FIG. 1, operative in accordance with an embodiment of the invention;

[0033] FIG. 7 is a simplified action diagram of an exemplary method of web browser control for use with the system of FIG. 1, operative in accordance with an embodiment of the invention;

[0034] FIG. 8 is a simplified action diagram of an exemplary method of web browser control for use with the system of FIG. 1, operative in accordance with an embodiment of the invention.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

[0035] Reference is now made to FIG. 1, which is a simplified conceptual illustration of a system for enforcing enterprise browser use, constructed and operative in accordance with an embodiment of the invention. In FIG. 1 a web browser **100** is configured to incorporate the functionality of conventional web browsers, such as those based on the Google™ Chromium™ architecture, and is additionally configured to operate as is described hereinbelow.

[0036] Web browser **100** may be hosted by any computing device, such as by a computer **102** that is connected to a computer network **104**, which may, for example, be a corporate intranet that provides access to one or more other networks **106**, such as the Internet. Copies of web browser **100** may, for example, be installed on multiple computing devices for use by individuals associated with an organization, such as by employees or contractors of a company, on company-owned computing devices or on non-company-owned computing devices, and configured to operate as described herein by system administrators and/or other parties authorized by the organization.

[0037] Web browser **100** is preferably configured to require that each user of web browser **100** be authenticated by a server **108**, also referred to herein as Enterprise Browser Identity Server (EBIS) **108**, before web browser **100** is allowed to perform one or more predefined operations, such as each time web browser **100** is executed and/or periodically thereafter, such as at predefined time intervals and/or before web browser **100** performs one or more operations predefined as requiring user reauthentication. An exemplary method of EBIS **108** authenticating web browser **100** is described hereinbelow with reference to FIG. 2. When web browser **100** is authenticated, EBIS **108** provides an encrypted authentication token **110** to web browser **100**. Thereafter, web browser **100** provides authentication token **110** as proof of authentication to a server **112**, also referred to herein as Browser Enforcement Cloud Server (BECS) **112**, as is described hereinbelow with reference to FIGS. 2-6.

EBIS Authentication

[0038] Reference is now made to FIG. 2, which is a simplified action diagram of an exemplary method of web browser authentication for use with the system of FIG. 1, operative in accordance with an embodiment of the invention. In FIG. 2, a user of web browser **100** enters their user ID, such as an email address, into a login screen provided by web browser **100**. Web browser **100** sends the user ID to EBIS **108**, which applies predefined criteria to map the user ID to an identity provider server **200**, also referred to herein as IdP **200**, that has been configured with an application object that is associated with EBIS **108**. EBIS **108** redirects web browser **100** to IdP **200**, preferably at a Uniform Resource Locator (URL) that IdP **200** has uniquely associated with EBIS **108**. The user enters their username and password into a login screen provided by IdP **200**. IdP **200** provides a response to web browser **100**, preferably where the response has been signed and/or encrypted in accordance with conventional techniques and in a manner that is decipherable by web browser **100**,

and redirects web browser **100** back to EBIS **108**. The response includes a “code challenge” object in accordance with conventional IdP techniques. Web browser **100** provides the IdP response to EBIS **108** which decrypts and verifies the IdP response. EBIS **108** uses the “code_challenge” object to generate authentication token **110** and a refresh token, where authentication token **110** preferably includes the user's user ID and a tenant ID of a tenant associated with the user, such as the user's employer. EBIS **108** sends authentication token **110** and the refresh token to web browser **100**, preferably where authentication token **110** and the refresh token have been signed and/or encrypted in accordance with conventional techniques and in a manner that is decipherable by BECS **112**, where BECS **112** is configured to authenticate authentication token **110** and the refresh token in accordance with conventional techniques. Thereafter, all communications sent by web browser **100** to BECS **112** include authentication token **110**, such as in a cookie or header, whereupon BECS **112** either validates authentication token **110** or determines that authentication token **110** is invalid or expired.

IP-Based Control-IdP

[0039] Reference is now made to FIG. **3**, which is a simplified action diagram of an exemplary method of web browser control for use with the system of FIG. **1**, operative in accordance with an embodiment of the invention. In FIG. **3**, a user of web browser **100** instructs web browser **100** to access a resource at a user-specified URL at a web server **300**. Web browser **100** is configured, such as in accordance with a predefined policy, to allow web browser **100** to request the user-specified URL from web server **300**. Web server **300** receives the request from web browser **100** and requests identification from the user, such as an email address or login and password, with which web server **300** is previously configured to associate with a predefined IdP URL at an IdP **302**, such as a predefined IdP URL at that is uniquely associated with a specific IdP tenant. Web server **300** then redirects web browser **100** to the IdP URL at IdP **302** for authentication. Rather than directly access the IdP URL at IdP, web browser **100** sends to BECS **112** authentication token **110** together with the request by web browser **100** to access the IdP URL, such as in accordance with a predefined policy with which web browser **100** is configured. One non-limiting example of such a policy may require web browser **100** to send to BECS **112** all requests to access redirection URLs. Another non-limiting example of such a policy may require web browser **100** to send to BECS **112** a request to access a user-specified URL or a redirection URL if the URLs or their domains or subdomains appear on a predefined list with which web browser **100** is configured or that is otherwise accessible to web browser **100**. BECS **112** validates authentication token **110** in accordance with conventional techniques. If authentication token **110** is valid, BECS **112** determines whether the request to access the IdP URL is authorized, such as by determining whether the current user of web browser **100** and/or a tenant associated with the user are authorized to access the IdP URL, such as in accordance with a predefined policy with which BECS **112** is configured. If access to the IdP URL is authorized, BECS **112** sends to IdP **302** the request by web browser **100** to access the IdP URL. IdP **302**, having been previously configured to associate the IdP URL for use with incoming requests from BECS **112**, and having been previously configured with one or more predefined valid IP addresses that are associated with BECS **112**, is configured to block attempts to access the IdP URL that are received from IP addresses that are not among the predefined valid BECS IP addresses. If IdP **302** determines that the request to access the IdP URL was received from a valid BECS IP address, IdP **302** sends a response to BECS **112**, which BECS **112** then sends to web browser **100**. The process of IdP **302** authenticating the user of web browser **100** then continues in accordance with conventional techniques, but with BECS **112** proxying communications between web browser **100** and IdP **302** until the user is authenticated and redirected by IdP **302** to access the resource to which the user originally requested access at the user-specified URL.

Ip-Based Control-Non-IdP

[0040] Reference is now made to FIG. **4**, which is a simplified action diagram of an exemplary

method of web browser control for use with the system of FIG. 1, operative in accordance with an embodiment of the invention. In FIG. 4, a user of web browser **100** instructs web browser **100** to access a resource at a user-specified URL at a web server **400**. Web browser **100** is configured, such as in accordance with a predefined policy, to require web browser **100** to request the user-specified URL from BECS **112**. Web browser **100** sends to BECS **112** authentication token **110** together with the request by web browser **100** to access the user-specified URL, such as in accordance with a predefined policy with which web browser **100** is configured and that applies to the user-specified URL. BECS **112** validates authentication token **110** in accordance with conventional techniques. If authentication token **110** is valid, BECS **112** determines whether the request to access the user-specified URL is authorized, such as by determining whether the current user of web browser **100** and/or a tenant associated with the user are authorized to access the user-specified URL, such as in accordance with a predefined policy with which BECS **112** is configured. If access to the user-specified URL is authorized, BECS **112** sends to web server **400** the request by web browser **100** to access the user-specified URL, where the request must first pass through an intermediary **402**, such as a firewall, load balancer, or reverse proxy, en route to web server **400**. Intermediary **402**, having been previously configured with one or more predefined valid IP addresses that are associated with BECS **112**, is configured to block attempts to access the user-specified URL that are received from IP addresses that are not among the predefined valid BECS IP addresses. If intermediary **402** determines that the request to access the user-specified URL was received from a valid BECS IP address, intermediary **402** sends the request to web server **400**. BECS **112** then sends to web browser **100** any response it receives from web server **400**. Thereafter, BECS **112** continues to proxy communications between web browser **100** and web server **400** via intermediary **402**.

SAML IdP Control

[0041] Reference is now made to FIG. 5, which is a simplified action diagram of an exemplary method of web browser control for use with the system of FIG. 1, operative in accordance with an embodiment of the invention. In FIG. 5, a user of web browser **100** instructs web browser **100** to access a resource at a user-specified URL. Web browser **100** is configured, such as in accordance with a predefined policy, to allow web browser **100** to request the user-specified URL from web server **500**. Web server **500** receives the request from web browser **100** and requests identification from the user, such as an email address or login and password, with which web server **500** is previously configured to associate with a predefined IdP URL at an IdP **502**, such as a predefined IdP URL that is uniquely associated with a specific IdP application. Web server **500** redirects web browser **100**, together with a Security Assertion Markup Language (SAML) request, to the IdP URL at IdP **502**. IdP **502** authenticates the user in accordance with conventional techniques, and determines, having been previously configured to do so, that the user is to be provided with the SAML response and redirected to BECS **112**. Web browser **100** sends to BECS **112** authentication token **110** together with the SAML response. BECS **112** validates authentication token **110** in accordance with conventional techniques. If authentication token **110** is valid, BECS **112** validates the SAML response and determines whether access to the resource specified in the SAML response is authorized, such as by determining whether the current user of web browser **100** and/or a tenant associated with the user are authorized to access the resource specified in the SAML response, such as in accordance with a predefined policy with which BECS **112** is configured. If access to the resource is authorized, BECS **112** signs the SAML response using a SAML certificate with which web server **500** has been previously configured, and redirects web browser **100**, together with the signed SAML response, to web server **500** which validates the SAML response using the aforementioned SAML certificate and, if the SAML response is valid, allows the user access to the resource.

Inline Network Enforcement

[0042] Reference is now made to FIG. 6, which is a simplified action diagram of an exemplary

method of web browser control for use with the system of FIG. 1, operative in accordance with an embodiment of the invention. In FIG. 6, web browser **100** is configured with an identifier **600**, such as a predefined digital token, header, or certificate. Web browser **100** is further configured to include identifier **600** in outgoing communications, such as in all outgoing communications, or only in communications to predefined destinations with which web browser is configured, such as by BECS **112**. Web browser **100** may be further configured to sign and/or encrypt identifier **600** in accordance with conventional techniques before including identifier **600** in an outgoing communication. Intermediary **602** is configured to check communications to determine whether identifier **600** is present within a received communication. In one embodiment intermediary **602** is configured to perform this check on communications that it receives from a predefined origin, such as any IP addresses within a corporate intranet, which includes the IP address of a computing device **604** that hosts web browser **100**. Intermediary **602** may be further configured to decrypt and/or otherwise validate identifier **600** in accordance with conventional techniques when identifier **600** is present within a received communication. Intermediary **602** is further configured to allow such communications in which identifier **600** is present to proceed to a destination that is indicated within the communication, such as to an application **606** via the Internet, and to prevent such communications in which identifier **600** is not present from proceeding to their indicated destination.

Managed Devices—Proxy Setting

[0043] Reference is now made to FIG. 7, which is a simplified action diagram of an exemplary method of web browser control for use with the system of FIG. 1, operative in accordance with an embodiment of the invention. In FIG. 7, web browser **100** is installed on a computer **700** that is configured to route all its outgoing communications to an intermediary **702**, such as a proxy server, whereas web browser **100** is configured to override this and instead route its outgoing communications to an intermediary **704**, such as a different proxy server. Intermediary **702** is configured to prevent some (e.g., associated with specific destinations) or all outgoing communications that intermediary **702** receives from proceeding to their destinations that are indicated within the communications, whereas intermediary **704** is configured to allow all outgoing communications that it receives to proceed to their destinations. In this embodiment, computer **700** and intermediaries **702** and **704** are “managed devices” whose settings are protected in accordance with conventional access-control techniques such that they are configurable only by authorized personnel. In another embodiment, web browser **100** overrides the proxy settings of computer **700** with empty proxy settings for all outgoing communications from web browser **100**, which enables all such communications from web browser **100** to proceed to their destinations without being routed through intermediary **704**.

Managed Devices—DNS

[0044] Reference is now made to FIG. 8, which is a simplified action diagram of an exemplary method of web browser control for use with the system of FIG. 1, operative in accordance with an embodiment of the invention. In FIG. 8, web browser **100** is installed on a computer **800** that is configured to use a Domain Name System (DNS) server **802** to resolve the domains of all URLs to which access is requested by software or hardware installed on computer **800**. Web browser **100** is configured to override this and instead use a DNS server **804** to resolve the domains of all URLs to which access is requested by web browser **100**. DNS server **802** is configured to is configured to not correctly resolve some (e.g., associated with specific domains) or all domain resolution requests that DNS server **802** receives, either at all or by resolving any or all the domain requests to a predefined blocking web page at a domain that is not associated with the domains of the requested URLs. DNS server **804** is configured to correctly resolve, in accordance with conventional techniques, all domain resolution requests that DNS server **804** receives. In this embodiment, computer **800** and DNS servers **802** and **804** are “managed devices” whose settings are protected in accordance with conventional access-control techniques such that they are configurable only by

authorized personnel. DNS server **804** is optionally configured as a secure DNS server that requires that access to DNS server **804** be authenticated, such as with an authentication token, where web browser **100** is configured with the authentication token required to access DNS server **804**.

[0045] Any aspect of the invention described herein may be implemented in computer hardware and/or computer software embodied in a non-transitory, computer-readable medium in accordance with conventional techniques, the computer hardware including one or more computer processors, computer memories, I/O devices, and network interfaces that interoperate in accordance with conventional techniques.

[0046] It is to be appreciated that the term “processor” or “device” as used herein is intended to include any processing device, such as, for example, one that includes a CPU (central processing unit) and/or other processing circuitry. It is also to be understood that the term “processor” or “device” may refer to more than one processing device and that various elements associated with a processing device may be shared by other processing devices.

[0047] The term “memory” as used herein is intended to include memory associated with a processor or CPU, such as, for example, RAM, ROM, a fixed memory device (e.g., hard drive), a removable memory device (e.g., diskette), flash memory, etc. Such memory may be considered a computer readable storage medium.

[0048] In addition, the phrase “input/output devices” or “I/O devices” as used herein is intended to include, for example, one or more input devices (e.g., keyboard, mouse, scanner, etc.) for entering data to the processing unit, and/or one or more output devices (e.g., speaker, display, printer, etc.) for presenting results associated with the processing unit.

[0049] Embodiments of the invention may include a system, a method, and/or a computer program product. The computer program product may include a computer readable storage medium (or media) having computer readable program instructions thereon for causing a processor to carry out aspects of the invention.

[0050] The computer readable storage medium can be a tangible device that can retain and store instructions for use by an instruction execution device. The computer readable storage medium may be, for example, but is not limited to, an electronic storage device, a magnetic storage device, an optical storage device, an electromagnetic storage device, a semiconductor storage device, or any suitable combination of the foregoing. A non-exhaustive list of more specific examples of the computer readable storage medium includes the following: a portable computer diskette, a hard disk, a random access memory (RAM), a read-only memory (ROM), an erasable programmable read-only memory (EPROM or Flash memory), a static random access memory (SRAM), a portable compact disc read-only memory (CD-ROM), a digital versatile disk (DVD), a memory stick, a floppy disk, a mechanically encoded device such as punch-cards or raised structures in a groove having instructions recorded thereon, and any suitable combination of the foregoing. A computer readable storage medium, as used herein, is not to be construed as being transitory signals per se, such as radio waves or other freely propagating electromagnetic waves, electromagnetic waves propagating through a waveguide or other transmission media (e.g., light pulses passing through a fiber-optic cable), or electrical signals transmitted through a wire.

[0051] Computer readable program instructions described herein can be downloaded to respective computing/processing devices from a computer readable storage medium or to an external computer or external storage device via a network, for example, the Internet, a local area network, a wide area network and/or a wireless network. The network may comprise copper transmission cables, optical transmission fibers, wireless transmission, routers, firewalls, switches, gateway computers and/or edge servers. A network adapter card or network interface in each computing/processing device receives computer readable program instructions from the network and forwards the computer readable program instructions for storage in a computer readable storage medium within the respective computing/processing device.

[0052] Computer readable program instructions for carrying out operations of the invention may be

assembler instructions, instruction-set-architecture (ISA) instructions, machine instructions, machine dependent instructions, microcode, firmware instructions, state-setting data, or either source code or object code written in any combination of one or more programming languages, including an object oriented programming language such as Java, Smalltalk, C++ or the like, and conventional procedural programming languages, such as the “C” programming language or similar programming languages. The computer readable program instructions may execute entirely on the user's computer, partly on the user's computer, as a stand-alone software package, partly on the user's computer and partly on a remote computer or entirely on the remote computer or server. In the latter scenario, the remote computer may be connected to the user's computer through any type of network, including a local area network (LAN) or a wide area network (WAN), or the connection may be made to an external computer (for example, through the Internet using an Internet Service Provider). In some embodiments, electronic circuitry including, for example, programmable logic circuitry, field-programmable gate arrays (FPGA), or programmable logic arrays (PLA) may execute the computer readable program instructions by utilizing state information of the computer readable program instructions to personalize the electronic circuitry, in order to perform aspects of the invention.

[0053] Aspects of the invention are described herein with reference to flowchart illustrations and/or block diagrams of methods, apparatus (systems), and computer program products according to embodiments of the invention. It will be understood that each block of the flowchart illustrations and/or block diagrams, and combinations of blocks in the flowchart illustrations and/or block diagrams, can be implemented by computer readable program instructions.

[0054] These computer readable program instructions may be provided to a processor of a general purpose computer, special purpose computer, or other programmable data processing apparatus to produce a machine, such that the instructions, which execute via the processor of the computer or other programmable data processing apparatus, create means for implementing the functions/acts specified in the flowchart and/or block diagram block or blocks. These computer readable program instructions may also be stored in a computer readable storage medium that can direct a computer, a programmable data processing apparatus, and/or other devices to function in a particular manner, such that the computer readable storage medium having instructions stored therein comprises an article of manufacture including instructions which implement aspects of the function/act specified in the flowchart and/or block diagram block or blocks.

[0055] The computer readable program instructions may also be loaded onto a computer, other programmable data processing apparatus, or other device to cause a series of operational steps to be performed on the computer, other programmable apparatus or other device to produce a computer implemented process, such that the instructions which execute on the computer, other programmable apparatus, or other device implement the functions/acts specified in the flowchart and/or block diagram block or blocks.

[0056] The flowchart illustrations and block diagrams in the drawing figures illustrate the architecture, functionality, and operation of possible implementations of systems, methods, and computer program products according to various embodiments of the invention. In this regard, each block in the flowchart illustrations or block diagrams may represent a module, segment, or portion of computer instructions, which comprises one or more executable computer instructions for implementing the specified logical function(s). In some alternative implementations, the functions noted in a block may occur out of the order noted in the drawing figures. For example, two blocks shown in succession may, in fact, be executed substantially concurrently, or the blocks may sometimes be executed in the reverse order, depending upon the functionality involved. It will also be noted that each block of the flowchart illustrations and block diagrams, and combinations of such blocks, can be implemented by special-purpose hardware-based and/or software-based systems that perform the specified functions or acts.

[0057] The descriptions of the various embodiments of the invention have been presented for

purposes of illustration, but are not intended to be exhaustive or limited to the embodiments disclosed. Many modifications and variations will be apparent to those of ordinary skill in the art without departing from the scope and spirit of the described embodiments.

Claims

1. A method of web browser control, the method comprising: configuring a web browser to send to a first computer server a request by a user of the web browser to access a resource at the first computer server, wherein the first computer server is configured to associate the computer user with a predefined identity provider network address, and redirect the web browser to access the identity provider network address; and configuring the web browser to send to a second computer server, in response to receiving the identity provider network address from the first computer server, an authentication token and a request to access the identity provider network address, wherein the second computer server is configured to determine whether the authentication token is valid, determine, responsive to the authentication token being valid, whether the request to access the identity provider network address is authorized, and send to the identity provider, responsive to the request to access the identity provider network address being authorized, the request to access the identity provider network address, and wherein the identity provider is configured to associate the identity provider network address for use with incoming requests from the second computer server, and block attempts to access the identity provider network address that are received from a sender network address that is not a predefined valid network address of the second computer server.
2. The method according to claim 1 wherein the web browser is configured with the authentication token.
3. The method according to claim 1 wherein the second computer server is configured to determine whether the request to access the identity provider network address is authorized by determining whether the user of the web browser is authorized to access the identity provider network address.
4. The method according to claim 1 wherein the second computer server is configured to determine whether the request to access the identity provider network address is authorized by determining whether a tenant associated with the user of the web browser is authorized to access the identity provider network address.
5. The method according to claim 1 wherein the identity provider is configured with the predefined valid network address of the second computer server.
6. The method according to claim 1 wherein the second computer server relays communications between the web browser and the identity provider until the user is authenticated by the identity provider and redirected by the identity provider to access the resource to which the user originally requested access at the first computer server.
7. A method of web browser control, the method comprising: configuring a web browser to send to a second computer server, in response to a request by a user of the web browser to access a resource at a first computer server, an authentication token and the request to access the resource at a first computer server, wherein the second computer server is configured to determine whether the authentication token is valid, determine, responsive to the authentication token being valid, whether the request to access the resource at the first computer server is authorized, and send to the first computer server, responsive to the request to access the resource at the first computer server being authorized, the request to access the resource at the first computer server, and wherein the request sent by the second computer server is sent via an intermediary configured to block attempts to access the first computer server that are received from a sender network address that is not a predefined valid network address of the second computer server.
8. The method according to claim 7 wherein the intermediary is any of a firewall, a load balancer, and a reverse proxy.

9. The method according to claim 7 wherein the second computer server relays between the web browser and the first computer server communications that are not blocked by the intermediary.
10. A method of web browser control, the method comprising: configuring a web browser to send to a first computer server a request by a user of the web browser to access a resource at the first computer server, wherein the first computer server is configured to associate the computer user with a predefined identity provider network address at an identity provider, provide a Security Assertion Markup Language (SAML) request to the web browser, and redirect the web browser to send the Security Assertion Markup Language (SAML) request to the identity provider network address, wherein the identity provider is configured to authenticate the user, provide a SAML response to the web browser, and redirect the web browser to send the SAML response to a second computer server; and configuring the web browser to send to the second computer server, in response to receiving the SAML response from the identity provider, an authentication token and the SAML response, wherein the second computer server is configured to determine whether the authentication token is valid, determine, responsive to the authentication token being valid, whether the request to access the resource at the first computer server is authorized, and send to the first computer server, responsive to the request to access the resource at the first computer server being authorized, the SAML response together with the request to access the resource at the first computer server, and wherein the first computer server is configured to determine whether the SAML response is valid and, responsive to the SAML response being valid, allow the user to access the resource.
11. A method of web browser control, the method comprising: configuring a web browser to send a predefined identifier in a communication sent by the web browser, wherein a destination of the communication is indicated within the communication; and configuring an intermediary to receive the communication, determine whether the identifier is present within the received communication, allow the received communication to proceed to the destination of the communication responsive to the identifier being present within the received communication, and prevent the received communication from proceeding to the destination of the communication responsive to the identifier being absent from the received communication.
12. The method according to claim 11 wherein the identifier is a digital token, header, or certificate.
13. The method according to claim 11 wherein the web browser is configured to include the identifier in all communications sent by the web browser.
14. The method according to claim 11 wherein the web browser is configured to include the identifier in communications sent by the web browser to one or more predefined destinations.
15. The method according to claim 11 wherein the intermediary is configured to determine whether the identifier is present within the communication received from a predefined origin.
16. The method according to claim 15 wherein the predefined origin includes one or more predefined network addresses.
17. The method according to claim 15 wherein the predefined origin includes the network address of a computing device that hosts the web browser.
18. A method of web browser control, the method comprising: installing a web browser on a computer that is configured to route to a first intermediary all communications sent by the computer, wherein the first intermediary is configured to prevent some or all of the communications from proceeding to destinations that are indicated within the communications; and configuring the web browser to override the configuration of the computer and allow all of the communications sent by the web browser to proceed to destinations that are indicated within the communications sent by the web browser, wherein the computer and the first intermediary are protected in accordance with an access-control technique making them configurable only by authorized personnel.
19. The method according to claim 18 wherein the first intermediary is a proxy server.
20. The method according to claim 18 wherein the configuring comprises configuring the web

browser to override the configuration of the computer and route to a second intermediary all communications sent by the web browser, wherein the second intermediary is configured to allow all of the communications sent by the web browser to proceed to destinations that are indicated within the communications sent by the web browser.

21. The method according to claim 18 wherein the configuring comprises configuring the web browser with empty proxy settings for all communications sent by the web browser, thereby enabling all of the communications sent by web browser to proceed to destinations that are indicated within the communications sent by the web browser without being routed through the first intermediary.

22. A method of web browser control, the method comprising: installing a web browser on a computer that is configured to use a first Domain Name System (DNS) server to resolve domains of all uniform resource locators (URLs) to which access is requested by software or hardware installed on the computer, wherein the first DNS server is configured to resolve all domain resolution requests, that the first DNS server receives, to a domain that is not associated with the domains of the requested URLs; and configuring the web browser to override the configuration of the computer and use a second DNS server to resolve domains of all URLs to which access is requested by the web browser, wherein the second DNS server is configured to correctly resolve any domain resolution request of any given requested URL, that the second DNS server receives, to a domain that is associated with the given requested URL, wherein the computer and the first and second DNS servers are protected in accordance with an access-control technique making them configurable only by authorized personnel.

23. The method according to claim 22 wherein the first DNS server is configured to resolve any of the domain resolution requests that the first DNS server receives to a predefined blocking web page at a domain that is not associated with the domains of the requested URLs.

24. The method according to claim 22 wherein the second DNS server is configured as a secure DNS server that requires that access to the second DNS server be authenticated with an authentication token, and wherein the web browser is configured with the authentication token.
